Practice Out Loud — Voice Interview Practice in ChatGPT

Nov 11, 2026 · @Chirag P C

A private, reviewable voice mode for job seekers to practise interview answers out loud in ChatGPT.

Team: ChatGPT India Mobile · **Contributors:** Chirag (PM) · **Status:** In Review · **Launching on:** after a 6-week build and a 4-week A/B test · **Resources:** Milestone 1 (landscape), Milestone 2 (research), prototype

Problem definition

Indian job seekers use ChatGPT heavily for job prep but type everything, even mock-interview practice, which is spoken by nature. Only 15% use voice weekly. They prep in shared spaces (82%), where speaking feels awkward (65%), and they need to check high-stakes text before it sends (53%); Hinglish misrecognition (44%) makes both worse. Fixing this gives ChatGPT a weekly voice habit with its core 21–30 base. It's urgent: only 32% of job seekers feel interview-ready (Apna, 2025), and Gemini already offers voice in 25+ Indian languages.

Goals and non-goals

Priority	Metric	Baseline	Target (4-week test)
P0	Weekly active voice users (job seekers)	15%	25%
P0	Sessions completed (3+ answers spoken)	new	40% of starts
P1	Voice answers per active user per week	new	8+
P1	Return to practice within 7 days	new	35%

Guardrails: p90 transcript latency under 1.5 s on 4G · session abandonment under 30% · no drop in text messages per user · voice-related 1★ reviews flat · cost per session within budget.

Non-goals: replacing general Voice mode or dictation; new Indic speech models; video or posture feedback; recruiter or job-listing features.

Validation and target audience

Research (Milestone 2, survey of 34 + 6 interviews): the barriers are social and about control, not awareness or privacy. 65% cite "people around me", 53% can't review before sending, 44% worry about accent or Hinglish, and 74% edit job prompts before sending. Only 12% cite privacy, yet 68% would try voice for mock interviews. In live tests, 4 of 6 lowered their voice or looked around before speaking.

> "My roommate is right there. I'm not saying 'tell me about yourself' to my phone." — P1, final-year B.Tech, Bengaluru

Segment: job seekers and freshers aged 21–30 on ChatGPT mobile. About 11M graduates aged 20–29 are unemployed (SWI 2026), and 94% of job seekers plan to use AI (LinkedIn, 2026). **Personas:** Riya, 22, preps in a Bengaluru PG with a roommate nearby; Arjun, 26, preps on the Hyderabad metro and needs polished answers; Neha, 23, in Indore, thinks in Hinglish. **Unmet need:** a private, low-pressure way to practise speaking, with feedback they trust.

Solution directions

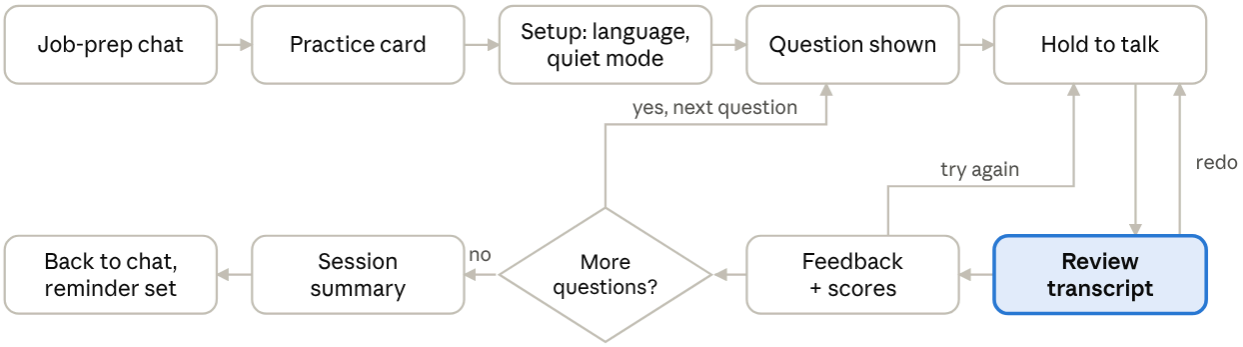
Direction	Barrier addressed	I	C	E	ICE
A. Review-before-send dictation	Control	5	8	8	320
B. Quiet mode (low-volume, earphones)	Social	6	5	6	180
C. "Say it instead" nudge on long prompts	Awareness	3	6	9	162
D. Practice Out Loud (guided voice mock interview)	Social + control + value	**9**	**7**	**5**	**315**

We picked **D**. It nearly ties A on ICE but has by far the highest impact: it creates a job where voice clearly beats typing, and it ships A's review step and B's quiet mode inside it.

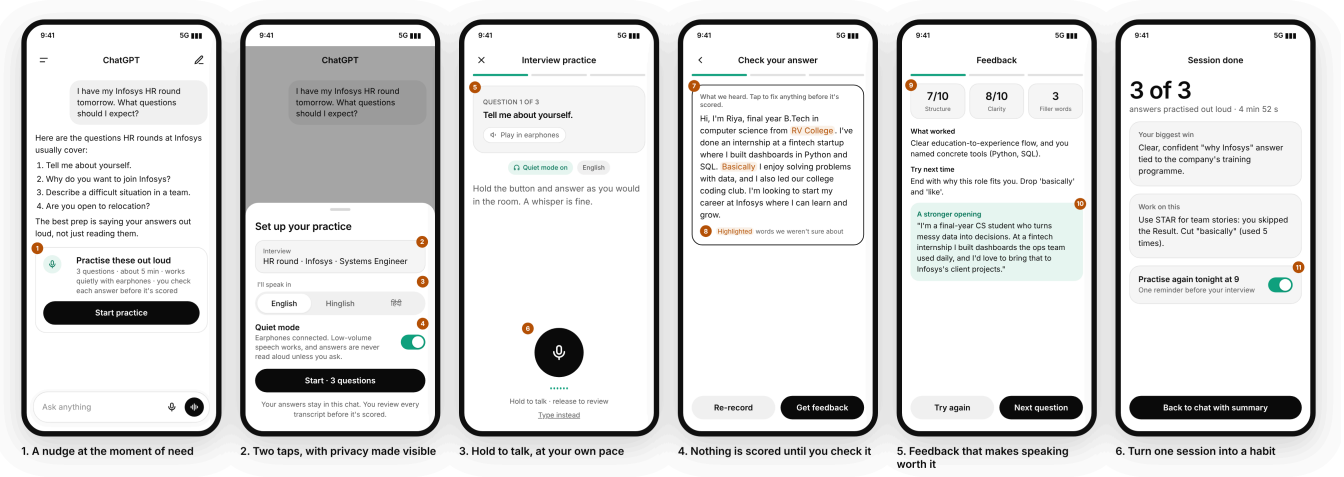
Solution: Practice Out Loud

When a user preps for an interview in chat, ChatGPT offers a short, private voice mock interview: hold to talk (quiet mode with earphones), check and fix the transcript, then get feedback. **AI-assisted prototype:** practice-out-loud.vercel.app.

Each answer loops until the user is happy, then gets scored



Practice Out Loud user flow · discover to return



1. A nudge at the moment of need
2. Two taps, with privacy made visible
3. Hold to talk, at your own pace
4. Nothing is scored until you check it
5. Feedback that makes speaking worth it
6. Turn one session into a habit

Annotations: (1) contextual card · (2) pre-filled context · (3) English, Hinglish or Hindi · (4) quiet mode with earphones · (5–6) hold to talk, "Type instead" always there · (7–8) editable transcript, unsure words flagged · (9–10) scores plus a stronger rewrite · (11) summary and reminder.

Key logic: a job-prep intent classifier (max 3 cards a week) triggers the card. GPT-Live-1.1 transcribes with a language hint, and a rubric scores the *edited* transcript. Raw audio is not stored.

Launch readiness and open questions

Design and usability test (wk 2) → build and QA on low-end Android and 4G (wk 6) → staff dogfood → A/B test on 10% of India job-prep users (wks 7–10). Ship if weekly active voice users rise 5+ points with no guardrail regression. **Checklist:** support article, Trust and Safety and privacy sign-off, speech capacity for placement season.

Open questions: show the card in general Voice mode too? Does whispered Hinglish work on low-end mics? **Decided:** build D before A; use hold-to-talk; score edited transcripts. **Descoped:** video feedback, more Indic languages, streaks. **Trade-off:** one high-intent moment over broad voice reach.